

The Journey Home

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01. Why Are We Here?

I've asked this question so many times.

What did God want when He created us?

What was the point of all of this?

What was He hoping for?

Did He need something?

Was He lacking in any way?

If He is perfect, if He is whole within Himself, then why create anything at all?

Deep down, I think we all want to know why we exist and if our lives truly matter. We might not always say it out loud, but in the quiet moments—when life slows down, when things don't go as planned, when the weight of everything feels too heavy—we wrestle with it.

Is there something greater?

A purpose beyond just surviving?

If God is real, if He truly made us, then what was He after?

The answer isn't complicated, but it still shakes me every time I think about it.

God wanted relationship.

Not just duty, not just obedience, not just people following a script. He didn't create us to serve Him from a distance, to be mere functionaries in His grand design, or to carry out some lifeless, religious routine. He wasn't looking for servants who perform out of obligation, nor for machines who execute His will without thought or feeling. He wasn't interested in distant admiration or robotic compliance. He wasn't looking for slaves or employees or mindless worshippers.

He wanted something real.

He wanted **me**.

Not as a project, not as an obligation, but as a son. As someone He could love, not just in theory, but in a way that was deeply personal and alive. He wanted someone He could pour Himself into, someone He could share life with, not because I was forced to be with Him, but because I wanted to. That's why He made me. That's why He made all of us—to walk with Him, to experience Him, to live in the fullness of His presence.

To know Him, not as a distant God or an abstract force, but as Someone who truly sees me, loves me, and wants me close.

And I know I'm not alone in this. We all want that kind of connection. We long for a relationship where we don't have to pretend, where we don't have to measure up, where we don't have to keep proving we're worthy of being loved. A relationship where we are known—fully, deeply, completely—and still accepted. Where every part of us—the good, the bad, the broken—is seen, and the response isn't rejection, but embrace. We don't just want to be tolerated; we want to be delighted in.

That's what God wanted when He made us. That's the heart of everything.

But it wasn't just about love, though love is at the center of it all. It was also about purpose. He created us to reflect Him. To live in harmony with Him, with the people around us, and with the world He made. He didn't set us on this earth to wander aimlessly, trying to carve out meaning in an existence that feels random and chaotic. He didn't leave us to struggle, to make sense of life on our own, to chase after fleeting pleasures that never truly satisfy. He made us to live fully connected—to

belong, to create, to love, to walk in the richness of life as it was meant to be.

And here's what gets me the most—God didn't just want me to know Him. He wanted to be known by me.

The God of the universe, the One who spoke light into existence, who crafted the galaxies and set the stars in place, didn't just make humanity to serve Him. He made us to share Himself. To open His heart. To let us see who He really is.

He doesn't just watch from a distance. He doesn't remain behind some cosmic veil, keeping Himself mysterious and unknowable. He invites me close. He whispers my name. He wants me to understand His heart, to experience His love in ways that are deeply personal and real. He wants relationship—not obligation, not forced devotion, but a connection so intimate that it changes me from the inside out.

And that's why there's this longing inside of me that nothing else can seem to fill.

I've felt it for as long as I can remember—that pull toward something I couldn't quite explain. That ache for something more. More than just existing. More than just going through the motions of life.

More than just waking up, working, striving, and chasing after things that never seem to satisfy.

I've tried to fill it in so many ways. I've searched for fulfillment in relationships, in accomplishments, in approval, in trying to be enough for people. I've built identities, chased after dreams, poured myself into things that seemed meaningful at the time. And yet, no matter what I accomplished, no matter how much love I received, no matter how much success I found—it was never quite enough.

Because what I was searching for wasn't a thing.

It was a Person.

The One who made me. The One who placed those desires in my heart in the first place.

So why am I here?

To know and be known.

To love and be loved.

To walk with God—not as a distant figure I strive to please, but as a Father who already delights in me.

To live as someone who is deeply connected, fully embraced, completely at home in His presence.

That's what I was made for. That's what we were all made for.

But if this is what God wanted, if this was the design all along, then why isn't it that simple?

Why does life feel so disconnected sometimes?

Why do I struggle to see Him, to hear Him, to experience the closeness I was created for?

Why does it feel like something is missing, like I'm constantly searching but never quite finding?

02. So What Went Wrong?

If this is what God wanted—if I was made for this kind of closeness with Him—then why isn't it that simple?

Why does it feel like something is missing?

Why does life so often feel distant, disconnected, and out of sync with the relationship I was created for?

Why do I struggle to see Him?

Why do I wrestle to hear His voice?

Why does His presence, which was supposed to be my home, feel so far away?

Something happened. Something changed.

I wasn't born into a world that feels like the one God originally intended. None of us were. From the moment I took my first breath, I stepped into something that was already fractured. The world was supposed to be a place where we walked freely with God, where we lived in perfect harmony with Him, with ourselves, with others, and with creation. Every part of existence was meant to reflect His presence—full of peace, full of

belonging, full of the deep connection we were designed for.

But instead, I was born into a world of striving.

A world of fear.

A world of disconnection.

A world that runs on self-effort, survival, and control.

And I feel it every day.

It wasn't always like this.

We've all heard the story of Adam and Eve—how they were given everything they needed, how they walked with God without shame, how they were whole and unbroken in His presence. And yet, something inside them questioned. Something whispered that maybe God was holding out on them. Maybe He wasn't enough. Maybe they needed to take matters into their own hands.

They didn't realize, like a parent protecting a small child, God wasn't keeping something from them—He was protecting them from themselves.

But they couldn't see it.

And so they made a decision.

A shift from trust to control.

From surrender to self-sufficiency.

From life with God to life on their own terms.

And everything changed.

They reached for control, thinking it would bring them freedom. They wanted to define things for themselves—to decide what was good and what was bad, to take the reins of their own lives, to chase after the things they thought would fulfill them. They wanted independence, believing it would make them stronger.

But instead, it made them weaker.

They had been connected to the very source of life, but they unplugged themselves, thinking they could sustain their own existence. They stepped away from the One who had created them for relationship, and in doing so, they severed the very connection that would fulfill what they were made for.

And from that moment, everything fell apart.

That single decision didn't just affect them. It affected all of us.

I wasn't just born into a broken world. I was born into a broken system.

A system where self is the dominant power source.
A system where I was taught to make my own way.
A system where I was told to build my own identity,
to fight for my place, to take care of myself because
no one else would.

That's the world I stepped into. That's the air I
breathed from the moment I was born.

And whether I realized it or not, I learned to operate
in a way that was completely opposite to what I was
made for.

Instead of resting in relationship, I learned to strive.
Instead of trusting, I learned to control.
Instead of depending on God, I learned to depend
on myself.

And I feel the weight of that every day.

It's why I chase things that never satisfy.
Why I reach for things that only leave me empty.
Why I wrestle with fear, insecurity, and the constant
sense that I have to prove myself.

I was created for something so much better. But
I've been running on a system that was broken
from the very beginning.

So here I am, carrying desires that were placed in me by God—desires for love, belonging, purpose, meaning.

But instead of receiving them from Him, I've spent my life trying to manufacture them on my own.

I've tried to create my own sense of identity.

I've fought to secure my own worth.

I've run after things that I thought would make me feel whole.

And no matter how hard I try, no matter what I achieve, it never quite works.

Because these desires were never meant to be fulfilled by me.

God placed them in me, but He never intended for me to carry the burden of making them happen.

I was supposed to bring them back to Him. To trust Him with them. To let Him fulfill them in the way He intended.

But instead, I fight. I strive. I push. I exhaust myself.

Because deep down, I'm still trying to be the source of my own life.

And that's the real problem.

It's not just that the world is broken. It's that I was born disconnected from the One who was meant to sustain me. I've been running on the wrong power source.

I was made to live fueled by Him. But instead, I've been trying to run on my own strength. And no matter how hard I push forward, no matter how much effort I put in, it's never enough.

So the real question isn't just what went wrong?

The real question is how do I reconnect?

Because if I was made for relationship, if I was designed for something more, then I don't want to spend my life chasing after things that will never satisfy.

I don't want to keep striving for something that was never mine to create.

I want to find my way back.

03. Finding My Way Back

If I was created for a deep, real relationship with God, if I was designed to live fully connected to Him, then why does it feel like I'm so far away? Why do I struggle to experience the closeness I was made for?

I wasn't supposed to live disconnected. I wasn't meant to strive, to chase after meaning, to feel like something is always missing. I was made to be at peace in His presence, to live from His love, to walk in step with Him. But I was born into a world that operates differently. A world that tells me to rely on myself. A world that tells me I have to fight for what I need, that I have to build my own life, that I have to take care of myself because no one else will.

So how do I get back to what I was made for?

How do I stop running on the wrong power source?

For a long time, I thought the answer was trying harder.

I thought if I just prayed more, read more, did more, then I could somehow fix what was broken inside me. I thought closeness with God was something I could earn—something I could achieve through effort, discipline, and sheer determination.

But no matter how much I tried, it never worked.

Because closeness with God isn't something I can achieve.

It's something I must receive.

This was never about me climbing my way up to Him.

It was always about Him making a way home for me.

And the truth is, I don't have to find my way back on my own.

God has already been reaching for me. He never left. He never turned away. I'm the one who's been running, grasping, striving—trying to do for myself what only He can do.

So if I want to return to the life I was made for, the first step isn't about doing more.

It's about surrendering control.

That's a hard word. Surrender.

It sounds like losing. Like weakness. Like giving up.

But I'm starting to realize it's not about losing something—it's about letting go of the things that were never mine to carry in the first place.

Surrender means I stop trying to be my own source of fulfillment.

It means I stop grasping for things that were always meant to be given, not taken.

It means I stop pushing, striving, exhausting myself with the weight of proving I belong, and instead let God show me that I already do.

But the truth I keep coming back to is this: God never asked me to make my own way.

He asked me to trust Him. That's what this has always been about. The first thing that broke in humanity's relationship with God was trust.

We believed the lie that He was holding out on us. We believed we had to take control, that we had to fight for what we wanted, that we had to make things happen for ourselves.

But trust is the only way back.

And trust doesn't mean just saying the right words or believing the right things—it means actually living like God is who He says He is.

It means trusting that His love for me isn't based on how well I perform.

It means trusting that He really does know what I need more than I do.

It means trusting that His way is better, even when I don't understand it.

Trust means handing over the deepest desires of my heart—the ones I've spent my whole life trying to make happen for myself—and giving them back to Him.

Because I can't fulfill them on my own.

I've tried.

I've pushed.

I've fought.

And all it's ever led to is frustration and emptiness.

The things I want most—the love, the purpose, the security, the meaning—they were never mine to manufacture.

They were always meant to come from Him.

And the moment I stop striving for them, the moment I let go, is the moment I finally make space to receive what He's been wanting to give me all along.

That's what surrender really is.

Not giving up, but giving back.

Letting God be the one to fulfill what He placed
inside of me in the first place.

So how do I find my way back?

I stop running.

I stop striving.

I stop trying to be my own source of life.

And I let Him be what He's always wanted to be.

My Father. My source. My home.

That's where this journey begins.

But surrendering is one thing.

Living it out?

That's another.

04. Learning to Live in Surrender

Surrender sounds simple in theory—let go, trust God, stop striving.

But actually living it?

That's a different story.

It's one thing to talk about trust when life is steady, when things make sense, when nothing is being stripped from me. It's another thing entirely when God asks me to surrender something that feels essential. Something I've worked for. Something I love. Something I thought I needed.

That's when surrender doesn't feel like peace.

It feels like loss.

I've spent most of my life running on self-sufficiency. I was trained to believe that if I wanted something, I had to make it happen.

If I wanted security, I had to build it.

If I wanted love, I had to earn it.

If I wanted purpose, I had to carve it out myself.

So when God asks me to let go, it feels unnatural. It feels risky.

What if I trust Him and things fall apart?
What if I give Him control and He doesn't come through?
What if surrender leaves me empty instead of fulfilled?

That fear is real.

It's the same fear that's been driving humanity since the very beginning—the doubt that God is actually good and that He can be trusted.

And that's the battle I have to fight every single day.

Because surrender isn't a one-time decision.

It's something I have to wake up and choose again and again.

I can say I trust God.

But when circumstances don't go my way, when I feel like I'm losing control, when I don't see the answers I want—I feel that old pull to take things back into my own hands.

I start wondering if surrender was a mistake.
I start calculating backup plans, exit strategies, ways to regain control.
I start questioning—Did I really hear God right?

And if I'm not careful, I slip back into striving.

I have to remind myself:

Surrender isn't just about releasing control. It's about choosing to believe that God's way is better than mine.

It's about trusting that when He asks me to let go, He isn't taking something from me—He's making room for something better.

It doesn't always feel better at first.

So what does that actually look like?

How do I stop living like I'm in charge of my own life and start living like I truly trust Him?

For me, it starts with recognizing where I'm still holding on.

Where am I still trying to control outcomes?

Where am I still chasing after things that were meant to be received, not forced?

Where am I still afraid that if I don't take charge, God won't show up?

Because if I'm honest, I don't want to just say I trust God. I want to actually live like I do.

And here's what I'm learning:

Surrender isn't passive.

It's not just sitting back and waiting for things to happen.

It's active trust—a choice to follow God's lead, even when it doesn't make sense, even when I don't have all the answers. It means trusting that if He's asking me to wait, it's because He's doing something I can't see yet. It means trusting that if He's closing a door, it's because He's protecting me from something I don't understand. It means trusting that His timing is better, His ways are higher, and that my striving will never accomplish what only He can do.

And when I start living this way—when I stop trying to force my way forward and instead learn to walk in step with Him—something changes.

The anxiety fades.

The pressure lifts.

The striving stops.

Because I'm no longer carrying the weight of making my own life work.

I'm finally free to just walk with Him.

But make no mistake—this is a battle. Surrender is not something I drift into. It's something I have to fight for. Because my instincts, my habits, my deeply ingrained patterns—they all tell me to take control. They tell me that if I don't push, if I don't strive, if I don't figure things out for myself—then I'll be left behind. That's why surrender has to be a daily practice.

A daily choice.

Every morning, I have to decide:

Am I going to live like God is enough for me today?
Or am I going to take things into my own hands?

Am I going to trust His timing?
Or am I going to manipulate circumstances to get what I want?

Am I going to live in rest?
Or am I going to keep striving, keep proving, keep exhausting myself with self-sufficiency?

Every time I take back control, I feel the weight of it. I feel the stress, the frustration, the endless loop of fear and overthinking. But every time I surrender—really surrender—I feel something else.

I feel peace.

I feel freedom.

I feel the quiet relief of knowing I don't have to carry this anymore.

Because surrender isn't about losing something. It's about gaining everything I was actually made for. It's about stepping into a life where I don't have to manufacture my own significance. A life where I don't have to hold everything together. A life where I actually believe God is who He says He is.

So that's where I'm at.

Learning to let go.

Learning to trust.

Learning to walk with God instead of trying to outrun Him.

And as I do, I'm starting to realize something—

This is what I was made for.

But there's one more thing I need to talk about.

Because surrendering to God isn't just about letting go of control.

It's about learning to receive.

And that's what comes next.

05. Learning to Receive

Letting go of control is one thing. Learning to receive?

That's something else entirely.

For so long, I thought of surrender as giving things up—laying down my plans, my desires, my need for control.

And it is.

Surrender does mean releasing the things I've been clutching too tightly, the things I've been using to build a sense of security, identity, and worth. But what I'm beginning to realize is that surrender isn't just about what I lose—it's about what I gain.

It's about making room.

Because God isn't just asking me to let go—He's been waiting to give me something better.

That part is harder than I expected.

I know how to strive. I know how to work for things, push forward, and make things happen. But receiving? That's unfamiliar territory. It feels unnatural. Uncomfortable, even. Because deep

down, something in me still believes that I have to earn everything.

I've spent my life trying to prove my worth, to work hard enough to be accepted, to make things happen for myself. So when God offers me something freely—His love, His guidance, His presence—my instinct is to resist it.

I find myself questioning it.

What do I have to do?

What's the catch?

Surely I have to prove I'm worthy before I can really have this.

But there is no catch. That's the whole point.

God isn't waiting for me to get my life together before He gives Himself to me. He's been offering Himself the entire time.

And yet, I hesitate.

I hesitate because receiving means trusting—trusting that I don't have to earn it. It means believing that I am actually loved—right now, as I am. Not the future version of me who's more mature, more disciplined, more faithful.

Just me. The real, flawed, messy me.

And that is hard to believe sometimes.

Because if I'm honest, it's easier to keep striving. At least then, I feel like I have some control. If I'm the one working for it, then I know where I stand. If I'm the one proving myself, then I can measure whether I deserve what I receive.

But grace doesn't work like that. God's love isn't a reward for effort—it's a gift. One He's been offering since the beginning. But if I've been running on self-sufficiency my whole life, how do I learn to receive instead?

For me, it starts with recognizing what God is already giving.

He's not distant. He's not withholding. He's been speaking, leading, loving me this whole time. But when I'm too busy striving, too focused on what I think I need, I miss it.

I don't see His presence in the small, quiet moments. I don't notice the ways He's been guiding me back to Him all along. Receiving means slowing down enough to see it.

It means letting His love in, even when I feel unworthy.

It means allowing Him to meet my needs, instead of

trying to handle everything myself.
It means opening my hands and saying,

"God, I trust You to give me what I actually need."

And I think that's where real peace comes from—not just from letting go, but from finally receiving the love and security I've been searching for all along.

Because here's what I'm starting to see:

I've been waiting for something from God, but He's already been offering Himself.

I thought I needed more control. More clarity. More certainty. But what I really needed was Him.

I was looking for direction, but what I actually needed was His presence. I was asking for provision, but what I truly needed was to trust that He is enough. Because God isn't just giving me things—He's giving me Himself. And yet, so often, I keep looking past Him, waiting for something else, something bigger, something that fits my idea of what I think I need.

But what if what He's offering is already everything?

What if the peace I've been chasing has been right in front of me this whole time?

What if receiving isn't about getting what I want, but finally accepting what He's been giving all along?

Because God has been offering Himself to me this entire time.

I'm done running.

I'm ready to receive.

But here's what I'm realizing—

What God gives doesn't always look the way I expect.

06. Doesn't Look Like What I Expect

I always thought that if I surrendered to God—if I truly let go and trusted Him—then He would give me the things I wanted. The dreams I had spent my life chasing. The desires I had clung to. I assumed that receiving from God meant getting the life I imagined, just without the stress of having to make it happen myself.

I thought surrender was about shifting the burden—letting God take control so that my life would unfold exactly the way I hoped. I assumed that if I was faithful, if I trusted Him, He would make things easier, clearer, more predictable.

But that's not how this works.

God does fulfill the desires of my heart. But not in the way I expect. I've learned that sometimes, He doesn't give me what I want—He gives me what I actually need.

And at first, that can feel disappointing.

It can feel like He's holding out on me. Like I trusted Him, and He didn't come through. Like I surrendered, and instead of receiving what I had been asking for, I was left waiting. Left empty-handed. Left wondering if He really sees me.

But over time, I've started to realize something:

He sees the full picture. I don't.

I ask for security, and He teaches me to trust.

I ask for love, and He reveals the places where I won't let myself be known.

I ask for purpose, and He strips away the things I thought defined me.

And none of it feels like a gift in the moment.

Sometimes, what He gives looks like waiting when I want action.

Looks like refining when I want comfort.

Looks like closed doors when I just want Him to say yes.

But He isn't being cruel. He isn't punishing me. He isn't ignoring my prayers.

He's leading me toward something better.

Something I wouldn't have chosen. Something I didn't even know I needed. Something far more fulfilling than what I was trying to build for myself.

God Isn't Giving Me Less—He's Saving Me From Settling

I see it now.

If God gave me everything I asked for, exactly when I asked for it, I would have settled for far less than what He actually had for me.

I would have clung to things that would have broken me.

I would have chased after dreams that would have left me empty.

I would have spent my life building something shallow, thinking it was everything I needed, never realizing how much deeper His plans actually go.

That's the hard part of receiving from God—it requires trust.

It means trusting that even when I don't understand, even when it feels like He isn't answering, even when I feel like I'm getting the opposite of what I asked for, He is still for me. It means believing that if He says no to something I desperately want, it's because He is protecting me from something I can't yet see. It means holding my desires loosely, knowing that He isn't ignoring them—He's shaping them, refining them, preparing me for something I wouldn't have been ready for before.

And that's where things get even deeper.

Because if God isn't giving me exactly what I ask for...

Then What Is He Giving Me?

Himself.

Every desire I have—love, belonging, purpose, security—it all leads back to Him.

I thought I was searching for things.

For achievements.

For relationships.

For a sense of worth.

But really, I was searching for Him.

And when I start to see that—when I start to realize that everything I need is actually found in Him—The striving starts to fade. The fear begins to lift.

Because I'm no longer chasing something just out of reach. I already have the greatest thing I could ever be given—God Himself.

That Changes Everything

It means my fulfillment isn't tied to circumstances.

It means my peace isn't dependent on getting what I want.

It means my joy isn't rooted in outcomes.

Because I already have the very thing my heart
was made for.

And that realization redefines everything.

It forces me to rethink what I've been longing for.

To reconsider what fulfillment actually looks like.

Because if true satisfaction isn't found in getting
what I think I need—

Then what does it actually look like?

07. Redefining Fulfillment

For most of my life, I thought fulfillment meant getting what I wanted—having my desires met, reaching my goals, feeling secure in what I had built. I believed that once I had checked all the right boxes—once I had the right relationships, once I had achieved a certain level of success, once I had created the life I envisioned—then I would finally feel at peace.

I was convinced that fulfillment was something I could accomplish. Something I could attain if I worked hard enough, planned well enough, and made all the right decisions.

But that's not what happened.

Every time I reached a milestone, I expected it to bring me the deep satisfaction I had been longing for. And every time, it came up short. It wasn't that those things didn't matter—they did. But they weren't enough. I got what I wanted, but I was still left wanting. I built the life I thought I needed, but there was still something missing. No accomplishment, no relationship, no amount of security ever fully satisfied the ache inside me.

And for a long time, I didn't know why.

I thought maybe I just hadn't gone far enough.

Maybe I needed to achieve more.

Maybe I needed to reach a higher level of success.

Maybe I needed to find a better relationship.

So I kept going.

I kept pushing.

I kept striving.

I kept chasing after the next thing.

But no matter what I did, fulfillment always felt just out of reach. I had spent my life looking for fulfillment in things, but what I was really craving wasn't a thing.

It was a Person.

I had spent years chasing after success, stability, and approval, but what I was really longing for was something only God could give.

And that realization wrecked me.

Because it forced me to ask a much harder question: What if real fulfillment isn't found in getting everything I want? What if it's found in being completely connected to the One who made me?

That thought changed everything.

Because if fulfillment is about getting what I want, then I will never stop chasing. There will always be another goal, another desire, another level of success that feels just out of reach. But if fulfillment is about being connected to God, then I don't have to keep running after the next thing.

I can be at peace—no matter what my circumstances look like.

I can be secure—even when life doesn't go the way I planned.

I can be fulfilled—not because I've finally gotten what I wanted, but because I finally know the One who satisfies.

Instead of constantly striving to create a life that feels fulfilling, I'm learning to receive the life that God is already giving me. Instead of believing that I'll be satisfied when I have this or when I get there, I'm learning to find joy in the presence of God right now. Instead of seeing surrender as losing something, I'm learning to see it as stepping into something greater.

Because fulfillment was never about achieving more.

It was always about being with Him.

This doesn't mean I stop desiring things.

It doesn't mean I stop dreaming.

It doesn't mean I stop planning.

It doesn't mean I stop wanting a good life.

But it does mean that I stop believing the lie that those things are what will complete me.

It means that instead of thinking I'll be happy when...

When I get the right job.

When I find the right relationship.

When I reach the right level of success.

When I finally feel like I'm enough...

I start realizing that none of those things were ever meant to be my source of fulfillment in the first place.

God isn't against my desires. He placed them inside me. But He knows something that I don't—that they can never be fully realized apart from Him.

He isn't ignoring my longings.

He's redirecting them.

Because my deepest desires—the ones that I’ve been trying to satisfy with success, with relationships, with achievement—are actually desires for Him.

I thought I wanted security, but I was really looking for the peace that comes from trusting Him.

I thought I wanted recognition, but I was really searching for the love that only He can give.

I thought I wanted success, but I was really longing for purpose that can only be found in Him.

So instead of chasing after things and asking God to bless them, I’m learning to go to Him first. To trust that whatever He gives—or withholds—is for my good. To believe that if He is all I have, then I already have everything I need. To stop grasping for control and instead walk in the peace of knowing that I am already fully loved, already fully held, already fully complete in Him.

Because this is what I was made for. Not an empty pursuit of fulfillment, but a life of union with God. But learning to live this way?

That’s another story.

Because I’ve spent my whole life being taught a different definition of success, of purpose, of

fulfillment. I've spent years believing that the only way to feel whole is to get what I want.

And unlearning that lie takes time.

It takes daily surrender.

It takes trusting Him when I don't see the full picture.

It takes being willing to receive what He's giving—even when it looks different than what I expected.

08. Unlearning the Lies

If I'm going to live in the kind of fulfillment that comes from being fully connected to God, then I have to unlearn a lot of what I've been taught about life, success, and even faith itself.

Because for so long, I've been conditioned to believe things that simply aren't true. I didn't even realize it at first. These ideas were ingrained in me so deeply that they felt like truth. They shaped how I saw myself, how I saw God, and how I believed life was supposed to work. And until I started to question them, I didn't even realize how much they were controlling me.

I believed that I had to prove my worth—that I needed to achieve something, be something, do something in order to be valuable.

I believed that God's love was something I had to earn—that He was pleased with me when I performed well and disappointed when I failed.

I believed that fulfillment came from getting what I wanted—that once I had the right job, the right relationship, the right circumstances, then I would finally be at peace.

I believed that if I worked hard enough, if I tried my best, if I got everything right, then I would be secure, content, happy.

But none of those things were true. And if I don't unlearn them, I will spend my life chasing things that were never meant to define me.

I will continue to strive.

I will continue to push.

I will continue to live with the pressure of trying to be enough, instead of receiving the truth that I already am.

So I'm asking God to re-teach me how to live. I'm learning that I don't have to prove my worth—I already have it. I was created in love, for love. My value isn't based on what I achieve. It isn't based on how successful I am, how capable I am, or how perfectly I perform. It is based on one thing: the fact that God calls me His. I'm learning that God's love isn't something I earn—it's something I receive.

It was never about my performance. It has always been about His heart. He doesn't love me more when I succeed or less when I struggle. His love is constant. I'm learning that fulfillment isn't found in getting what I want—it's found in being fully connected to God.

He isn't withholding good things from me.

He isn't ignoring my desires.

He isn't waiting for me to be better before He blesses me.

He is protecting me.

He is leading me.

He is shaping me.

And what He has for me is so much better than anything I could create for myself.

But unlearning these lies isn't easy.

It takes time.

It takes daily reminders.

It takes choosing to trust Him when everything in me wants to go back to my old ways of striving and control.

I know these lies are comfortable.

They are familiar.

They are deeply ingrained.

They are the default setting I've been operating from for most of my life.

And even though I know they aren't true, there are moments when I still believe them.

When I fail at something, the old voice whispers:

"See? You're only valuable when you succeed."

When I don't feel God's presence, another lie creeps in:

"Maybe He's disappointed in you. Maybe you haven't done enough."

When I don't get what I want, when things don't go the way I planned, I hear:

"If God really loved you, wouldn't He have given you what you asked for?"

And in those moments, I have to make a choice.

I can either listen to the lies. Or I can cling to the truth. Because the truth is—

God isn't withholding His love.

God isn't disappointed in me.

God isn't waiting for me to prove myself before He blesses me.

He already calls me His.

He already loves me completely.

He already has good things for me.

And the more I let go of these lies, the more I start to believe that God is really as good as He says He is.

And when I do—

The anxiety starts to fade.
The pressure begins to lift.
The striving comes to a stop.

Because I'm no longer trying to build a life that only God can give. I'm finally learning to live in the truth.
Truth Isn't Just Something I Believe—It's
Something I Walk In

But here's what I'm realizing:

Truth isn't just something I know in my head. It's something I have to live out in my life. It's something I have to choose—every single day. And that means I have to stop letting fear dictate my choices.

It means I have to stop believing that control is my safety net.

It means I have to start trusting God enough to step into a new way of living.

And that means learning to let go of fear and step into trust.

09. Letting Go of Fear

Unlearning the lies is one thing.

Living like I actually believe the truth?

That's something else entirely.

I can say I trust God.

I can tell myself that He's in control.

I can remind myself that His way is better than mine.

But when life doesn't go the way I expected, when things feel uncertain, when I don't see the answers I was hoping for—that's when fear creeps back in.

That's when the old lies start whispering again.

"What if God doesn't come through?"

"What if you're making a mistake?"

"What if letting go is the worst thing you could do?"

And suddenly, I feel that familiar pull—That urge to take things into my own hands. Fear tells me that if I don't control things, everything will fall apart. Fear tells me that if I don't have a backup plan, I'll regret it. Fear tells me that surrender is too risky, that I can't afford to fully let go, that trusting God is fine in theory but dangerous in reality.

And if I listen to fear, I'll go right back to where I started.

Right back to striving.

Right back to controlling.

Right back to manipulating situations so they work in my favor.

Right back to exhaustion.

However, I don't want to live like that anymore. I don't want to say I trust God while still living as if it all depends on me. I don't want to keep fear as a backup plan—just in case God doesn't come through. I don't want to cling to control because I'm afraid of what will happen if I don't.

I want to actually walk in the peace that comes from knowing He is who He says He is.

And that means I have to make a choice. Not just once.

Not just on the easy days. But every single day. Every single moment. I have to choose to trust.

Even when I don't understand.

Even when I don't feel it.

Even when everything in me wants to run back to what feels safer—what feels familiar.

Because trust isn't just a feeling.

It's a decision.

A choice.

It's believing that God is leading me, even when I don't see where we're going. It's walking forward, even when my legs are shaking. It's letting go, even when my hands still want to hold on. Because the truth is—

I cannot experience the fullness of God's peace while still clinging to my own control. I cannot step into trust while still holding onto fear. And I cannot live in freedom while still making decisions from a place of anxiety. But when I stop holding onto fear—When I finally let go of my backup plans—When I step fully into trust—Something happens.

Something I never could have grasped on my own.

I experience freedom. Not just the kind of freedom that sounds nice in theory—but real freedom.

Freedom from the pressure to make everything happen.

Freedom from the fear of failure.

Freedom from the lie that I have to hold my own life together, or it will fall apart.

Because when I trust God—I can breathe again. I can rest again. I can finally stop trying to prove myself and start receiving the security I was made for.

This Is the Life I Was Made For

Not a life of fear—but a life of trust. Not a life of striving—but a life of peace. Not a life of proving myself—but a life of knowing I am already fully loved. Because when I really trust God, when I stop waiting for certainty and just step into it—I realize something even deeper.

Something that changes everything.

Trust isn't just about surrendering control.

Trust is about knowing that I am safe.

10. Knowing That I Am Safe

Trust is hard because it feels like a risk. It feels like I'm stepping into the unknown, letting go of control, releasing my grip on the things I've spent my whole life trying to hold together.

It feels dangerous.

Because what if everything falls apart? What if I let go, and God doesn't catch me? What if trusting Him means losing more than I can handle?

But real trust—the kind that actually changes me—isn't built on blind faith.

It's built on something deeper.

It's built on knowing that I am safe.

Not safe in the sense that nothing bad will ever happen.

Not safe in the sense that life will always go the way I hope.

Not safe in the sense that I'll never experience pain, loss, or uncertainty.

But safe in the sense that no matter what happens, I am fully held by God.

I've spent so much of my life trying to create safety for myself.

I've built walls around my heart to keep from getting hurt.

I've made backup plans in case things didn't work out.

I've worked hard, trying to make sure I was never too vulnerable, never too exposed.

Because if I had control, I thought I would be safe. But here's what I'm learning: Real safety isn't found in control. Because control is an illusion.

I can plan every detail of my life,
I can build walls around my heart,
I can do everything in my power to protect myself from disappointment...

And still, life will be unpredictable.

Things will happen that I never saw coming.

People will let me down.

Doors will close.

Plans will unravel.

And no matter how much I try to prepare, I can't control everything. So what if real safety isn't found in having everything under control? What if real safety is found in knowing I am never alone?

Because that's the promise. That's what God has been saying from the very beginning:

I am with you.

Not just when I feel Him.

Not just when things are going well.

Not just when I've done everything right.

Always.

In the unknown—He is with me.

In the waiting—He is with me.

In the moments when I feel lost, when I don't have the answers, when I'm struggling to hold on—He is still with me.

And if I truly believe that—if I really take Him at His word—then I don't have to live in fear anymore.

I don't have to scramble to create security for myself.

I don't have to fight for control over things that were never mine to hold.

I don't have to carry the weight of making sure my life turns out the way I think it should.

Because I am safe.

Not because life is predictable.

Not because I have all the answers.

Not because I'm strong enough to handle everything that comes my way.

I am safe because I am held.

And That Changes Everything

It means I can move forward without fear.

It means I can rest instead of striving.

It means I can finally let go of the pressure to make everything work and instead walk in the peace of knowing that God is already ahead of me.

I was never meant to hold my own life together. I was meant to be held.

And when I really believe that—when I stop just saying that I trust Him and start living like it's true—something shifts.

I stop overthinking every step.

I stop worrying about the future.

I stop carrying burdens that were never mine to carry.

Because I don't have to be my own protector anymore.

I don't have to be the one holding everything together. I don't have to be the one making sure I don't fall apart. Because I am already held. And

now, knowing that I am safe in Him, I can start asking a different question.

If I no longer have to live in fear...Then what kind of life am I free to live?

11. Living Free

If I don't have to live in fear—if I am truly safe in God—then what kind of life am I free to live?

That question lingers, not just as a thought, but as a reality I haven't fully stepped into.

For so long, I thought freedom meant doing whatever I wanted. Making my own rules. Controlling my own path. Being the one in charge, beholden to no one, able to shape my life exactly how I wanted it to be. I thought that kind of independence would give me peace, that if I could just build the perfect life, I wouldn't have to feel uncertain, wouldn't have to worry about things falling apart, wouldn't have to experience fear at all.

But I was wrong.

The more I tried to control things, the more trapped I became—trapped by anxiety, by pressure, by the constant weight of trying to make sure everything turned out the way I thought it should. I convinced myself that if I could just be smart enough, careful enough, strong enough, then I could finally stop feeling so restless.

But no matter how much I planned, no matter how much effort I put in, there was always something

outside of my grasp. And every time life didn't go the way I expected, the fear would creep back in, whispering that I needed to work harder, do better, be more.

I wasn't free. I was exhausted.

And that's when I started to realize something—real freedom isn't found in control.

It's found in trust.

It's found in knowing I don't have to prove myself anymore, because I am already fully loved.

It's found in knowing I don't have to fear the future, because God is already leading me.

It's found in knowing I don't have to keep striving for belonging, because I already have it.

This is the life I was created for—not a life of white-knuckled survival, but a life where I can actually breathe. A life where I don't have to spend every moment planning, fixing, and bracing for disaster. A life where I can finally stop running ahead of God and instead walk with Him—fully present, fully alive, fully trusting that He is taking care of me.

But trust is still hard.

Because control, even though it exhausts me, feels safe. It makes me feel like I have a say in how my life plays out. It makes me feel like I can protect myself from pain, from disappointment, from failure. So even when I know I'm supposed to trust God, I still hesitate. I still want to keep one foot in the life I built for myself, just in case His plan doesn't turn out the way I hoped.

But that's not freedom. That's just another form of fear.

Because when I hold onto control, what I'm really holding onto is the belief that God might not actually be enough for me. That if I surrender, I'll end up with less. That if I let go, I'll regret it.

But that's the lie.

The truth is, when I finally stop striving—when I finally release my grip and let God be the one who carries me—I don't lose anything. I gain everything.

I don't have to be afraid of failure, because my mistakes don't define me.

I don't have to carry the weight of making my life work, because it was never mine to hold.

I don't have to hold back from stepping into what He's calling me into, just because I'm afraid I won't be enough.

Instead of constantly hesitating, I can move forward, not because I have everything figured out, but because I know He does.

And that's what freedom really is.

It's not the absence of risk or the guarantee that everything will go my way. It's the confidence that I am already secure, already held, already enough. I can take risks. I can love without fear. I can surrender without hesitation. I can step into what God has for me without needing to control the outcome.

This is the paradox of the life God calls me to—surrender leads to freedom.

The more I let go, the more I step into the life I was meant for.

The more I stop striving, the more I receive what was always mine to begin with.

The more I trust, the more I actually live.

Because real life isn't found in chasing after things that were never meant to satisfy me. It's found in walking with God, learning what it means to truly be at peace.

This is what I was made for. And now the question isn't, *What do I need to do to get there?* The

question is, *What is stopping me from living in this freedom right now?*

12. What's Stopping Me?

If I was made for this kind of freedom—if I was created to live fully at peace, fully trusting, fully connected to God—then why does it still feel so difficult to step into it?

Something is holding me back.

It's not that I don't believe in God. It's not that I don't want to trust Him. But there's something deep inside me that resists. Something that tightens its grip every time I try to let go. Something that whispers, *What if it's not that simple? What if you're wrong? What if letting go means losing everything?*

And that something is fear.

Even though I know I am safe, even though I know God is trustworthy, there is still a part of me that wants to hold on—just in case.

Just in case I need to step in and fix something.
Just in case things don't work out the way I hope.
Just in case surrender turns out to be a mistake.

Because freedom is costly.

To step into the life I was created for, I have to leave behind the life I built for myself.

To embrace peace, I have to let go of control.
To walk in trust, I have to lay down my own plans.

And that is terrifying.

What if God's way leads me somewhere I don't
want to go?
What if I surrender everything and end up empty?
What if I trust Him fully and things still fall apart?

These are the thoughts that keep me from truly
stepping into freedom.

Because as much as I want to believe that trusting
God will be easy, part of me is afraid that surrender
might come with loss.

It's strange—I already know what life looks like
when I try to control it myself.

I know the weight of striving.
I know the exhaustion of trying to hold everything
together.
I know the endless cycle of chasing things that
never truly satisfy.

And I don't want to live that way anymore.

But at the same time, the fear of the unknown
keeps me from fully stepping into trust.

Because at least in control, I know what to expect.
At least in striving, I feel like I have a say.
At least in clinging, I don't have to face the
possibility that surrender might lead me somewhere
unexpected.

But is clinging to control really better than trusting
the One who created me?

That's the question I have to wrestle with.

Because at the core of it all, this isn't really about
fear. It's about what I actually believe about God.

Do I believe He is good?

Do I believe He loves me?

Do I believe He actually knows what is best for
me—even more than I do?

Because if I do—if I really, truly do—then why am I
still holding back?

Why am I still trying to control what was never mine
to carry?

Why am I still acting like I am safer in my own
hands than in His?

At the end of the day, there is only one thing
standing between me and the life I was created for.

Trust.

Not my circumstances.

Not my past failures.

Not my ability to figure everything out before I move forward.

Just trust.

And trust is a choice.

I can choose to stay where I am, clinging to control, running in circles, chasing after a version of peace that never lasts.

Or I can choose to take the next step, even when I don't feel ready, even when I don't have all the answers, even when I don't see the full picture. Because what if real freedom has been waiting for me this entire time? What if the only thing stopping me... is me?

Maybe that's the real question. Not *what's stopping me?*

But *what am I waiting for?*

13. What Am I Waiting For?

If I already know that my way leads to exhaustion—if I already know that striving will never give me what I'm looking for, if I already know that God is offering me something better—then why am I still standing here, hesitating?

What am I waiting for?

Am I waiting for a sign? A flashing light, a booming voice from heaven, something that makes the next step obvious? Am I waiting for a moment of absolute certainty where I feel no fear, no doubt, no hesitation? Am I waiting for everything to make perfect sense, for all my questions to be answered, for all my insecurities to disappear?

Because if that's what I'm waiting for, I will be waiting forever.

God never promised me certainty. He never promised that I would understand everything before I took the first step. He never said that trust would come without fear, without resistance, without moments of doubt that make me want to turn back.

He just said, **"Follow Me."**

He just said, **"Let go."**

He just said, **"I will be with you."**

For years, I've told myself that I just need a little more time, a little more clarity, a little more proof that stepping out in faith won't leave me empty-handed. I convince myself that once I feel strong enough, once I feel ready, then I'll move. But when is that moment coming?

I keep waiting for the fear to go away before I trust, but what if trust is what makes the fear go away? I keep waiting to feel completely prepared before I obey, but what if obedience is what makes me prepared? I keep waiting for my heart to be at peace before I let go, but what if peace is only found on the other side of surrender?

I have spent so much time waiting, and for what? Some guarantee that everything will turn out exactly how I want? Some assurance that trusting God won't cost me anything? Some control over a life I keep saying isn't mine to control?

At some point, I have to decide that the cost of staying where I am is greater than the cost of taking the next step.

Because the longer I wait, the more I realize that waiting isn't as safe as it seems.

Waiting keeps me stuck in a cycle of hesitation, fear, and second-guessing. It makes me feel like

I'm in control, like I still have a say in how things unfold, but in reality, I'm just paralyzed. I'm not moving forward, and I'm not really staying still either. I'm just trapped in the in-between—too afraid to keep striving, too afraid to let go.

And what kind of life is that?

Waiting might feel like wisdom, but it can just as easily be fear disguised as patience. I tell myself I'm waiting on God, but what if God has been waiting on me? Waiting for me to stop looking for excuses. Waiting for me to stop asking for certainty. Waiting for me to take a step, even if my hands are shaking and my heart is racing.

I can keep waiting—waiting for all the fear to disappear, waiting for God to prove Himself on my terms, waiting for a life that feels safer, more predictable, more in my control.

Or I can move.

I can take the step, even if I don't feel ready.

I can surrender, even before I see what's on the other side.

I can trust, even when I don't have all the answers.

Because faith isn't about being fearless. It's about stepping out, even while fear is still whispering in my ear. It's about choosing to move forward, even when my legs feel unsteady. It's about saying yes to God, even before I see the full picture.

I've spent too much time believing that trust is something that happens once I feel strong enough, when really, trust is something I choose while I still feel weak. If I wait until I have no fear, I will never move. If I wait until I understand everything, I will never trust. If I wait until I feel ready, I will never actually live the life I was created for.

And I don't want to spend my life standing at the edge of trust, thinking about what it would be like to fully surrender but never actually stepping into it. I don't want to look back years from now and realize that the only thing standing between me and the life God had for me was my own hesitation.

What if the fear that's keeping me stuck isn't based on truth?

What if the risk I'm so afraid of isn't a risk at all?

What if everything I've been waiting for has been waiting for me to take the next step?

Maybe the better question isn't *what am I waiting for?*

Maybe the better question is, *what happens when I finally step into this?*

14. Stepping Into the Life I Was Made For

I know what God wants. I know what's been holding me back. I know that freedom, peace, and fulfillment are found in surrender. I know that my striving hasn't led me to rest, that my fear hasn't kept me safe, and that my control hasn't given me certainty.

But now comes the real question—how do I actually live this?

Because knowing the truth isn't the same as walking in it. It's one thing to say I trust God. It's one thing to believe that His way is better, that His plans are higher, that His love is enough. But it's another thing entirely to wake up every day and live like I believe it.

This isn't a one-time decision. It's not something I can just pray about once and be done with.

This is a way of living.

And that means I have to start treating trust not as something I lean on when I have no other choice, but as my first instinct.

It means waking up and saying, God, today I choose to trust You. Today I choose to let go of the weight I wasn't meant to carry. Today I choose to believe that You are enough for me—more than my plans, more than my comfort, more than my ability to control the outcome.

On some days, the decision will seem straightforward. Trust will come naturally, and I'll feel the peace that surrender brings. Other days, it won't. I'll wake up feeling the familiar pull toward control. I'll feel the urge to step back into old patterns, to pick up burdens I already laid down, to take matters into my own hands again.

And that's okay.

Because trust isn't about never feeling fear—it's about choosing not to let fear be what leads me.

And here's what I'm realizing—the more I practice surrender, the more natural it becomes.

At first, trust feels uncomfortable, almost unnatural. Like I'm free-falling. Like I'm stepping off a ledge into nothingness. Like I'm walking into the unknown without a safety net. Everything in me wants to reach for something solid, something familiar, something I can control.

I want to have a plan.

I want to know what's coming.

I want to feel like I'm making the right choices, that I'm doing enough, that I'm not making a mistake by letting go.

But then, something shifts.

I start to see how God is already providing.

I start to see how He is already leading.

I start to see how He is already making a way where I thought I had to make one myself.

Slowly, surrender stops feeling like loss. It starts feeling like relief.

I don't have to carry everything.

I don't have to figure everything out.

I don't have to prove myself.

I can just walk with Him.

And the more I do, the more I realize—this is what I was made for.

I wasn't made for a life of constant striving. I wasn't made to carry the crushing weight of my own existence. I wasn't made to spend my days in fear, worrying about whether I measure up, wondering if

I'm enough, trying to earn what has already been given.

I was made for peace.

I was made for trust.

I was made to live in the presence of God without barriers, without hesitation, without fear.

But if I want this to be my reality, then I have to stop treating surrender like an event and start treating it like a way of life. Because this isn't just about letting go once. This is about living surrendered every single day.

So what does that actually look like? How do I stop making trust something I turn to only when my own strength runs out, and start making it my foundation?

For me, it starts with recognizing the places where I still haven't let go.

Where am I still trying to control outcomes?

Where am I still clinging to my plans, my expectations, my idea of how things should go?

Where am I still afraid that if I let go, God won't come through?

Because if I don't acknowledge where I'm still holding on, I can't truly let go.

And here's what I'm learning—surrender isn't passive. It's not about sitting back and waiting for things to magically happen. It's an active choice.

It means trusting that if He's asking me to wait, it's because He's doing something I can't see yet. It means trusting that if He's closing a door, it's because He's protecting me from something I don't understand. It means trusting that His timing is better, His ways are higher, and that my striving will never accomplish what only He can do.

When I start living this way—when I stop trying to force my way forward and instead learn to walk in step with Him—something changes.

I don't want surrender to be something I wrestle with every time life doesn't go the way I planned. I don't want trust to be my last resort when I've exhausted all other options.

I want surrender to be my first response.

My natural way of living. That means I have to stop treating God like a safety net and start treating Him like my foundation. I have to stop waiting for everything to make sense before I trust Him. I have to stop holding on to control like it's my lifeline, when He is the only one who can truly sustain me.

And the more I do this, the more trust becomes second nature. At first, it feels unnatural. Like I'm stepping into unknown territory. But then, I start to realize I'm not walking into nothingness—I'm walking into His presence.

And in His presence, I am safe. In His presence, I am provided for. In His presence, I can breathe.

I wasn't created for a life of striving. I wasn't created to live burdened by the fear of not measuring up.

I was created for peace.

I was created for rest.

I was created to live fully surrendered to the One who holds everything together—including me.

So now, the question isn't *how do I surrender?*

The question is, *how do I live a life where surrender is my new normal?*

15. Making Surrender My New Normal

I want surrender to be my first response, my natural way of living.

But how do I get there? How do I move from surrender being a struggle to surrender being a way of life?

Because right now, trust doesn't always come naturally. Right now, my instinct is to reach for control when things feel uncertain. My first reaction is to try to fix things myself, to come up with a backup plan, to make sure I'm not caught off guard. Even when I know God is trustworthy, there's still a part of me that hesitates.

So how does that change?

The answer isn't a formula. It's not a checklist. It's not about forcing myself to let go.

Trust becomes natural when I know who I'm trusting

Surrender isn't about trying harder to trust—it's about building a relationship so deep that trust becomes my default. Because the more I know God, the more I trust Him. The more I trust Him, the

easier it is to surrender. The more I surrender, the more I walk in peace.

So this isn't about forcing myself to trust—it's about getting closer to the One who is already trustworthy.

And that means I have to start living differently.

I have to stop treating God like someone I turn to only when I need an answer and start walking with Him every single day. I have to stop seeing surrender as a moment of crisis and start seeing it as a daily practice. I have to stop separating my spiritual life from my real life and start inviting Him into everything.

Because surrender isn't just about what I do—it's about who I am becoming.

I am becoming someone who trusts God more than I trust myself.

I am becoming someone who listens for His voice before making my own plans.

I am becoming someone who no longer carries burdens that were never mine to hold.

And this is what I'm realizing: this kind of life isn't built overnight.

It's not the result of one big, dramatic moment of surrender. It's not something I wake up one morning having mastered.

It's built in the small, ordinary moments.

It's built in the way I respond when things don't go my way.

It's built in how I pray—not just for solutions, but for closeness.

It's built in how I listen—not just when I want something, but when I simply want to know Him.

Every single day, I have a choice.

Do I cling to control, or do I trust God instead? Do I react out of fear, or do I pause and let Him lead? Do I rush ahead, trying to force my own way, or do I wait and believe He is working?

Because every time I choose trust, trust becomes my new normal. Every time I choose surrender, surrender starts to feel less like a loss and more like freedom. And the more I choose to live this way, the more natural it becomes.

I don't want to keep wrestling with surrender. I want to live in it. I don't want to keep questioning if God is enough. I want to walk in the confidence that He is. Because that's the life I was made for.

A life where I am no longer ruled by fear.
A life where I am no longer weighed down by
striving.

A life where I don't just say I trust God—I actually
live like I do.

And as I step into this way of living, I know this isn't
the end of the journey.

It's just the beginning.

Because now that I know what I was made for, I
have to ask...

What does it look like to truly live this out?

16. Living This Out

I used to think trust was something that would just happen to me one day—like if I got everything right, if I read my Bible enough, prayed enough, surrendered enough, then suddenly I'd wake up feeling totally secure, totally at peace, totally free from fear. I thought trust was something that would just click if I worked hard enough at it.

But that's not how trust works.

Trust isn't a destination.

It's not a milestone I finally reach. It's not something that just falls into place once I've done enough, learned enough, or grown enough. Trust isn't the end of the journey—it's the way I walk the entire thing.

Trust is a way of living. A way of seeing. A way of responding to the world around me. And if I want surrender to be my new normal, then I have to train my heart to live in trust, not just believe in it. That means trust isn't something I practice only when life feels uncertain. It's not something I fall back on when I've exhausted all other options. It's something I choose every single day.

Trust is built in the small choices

Every single day, I will be faced with choices. Do I cling to control, or do I release my grip? Do I react in fear, or do I pause and let God speak? Do I rush ahead and make things happen, or do I wait and trust that He is leading?

And the choices I make—those small, ordinary, seemingly insignificant choices—are shaping who I am becoming.

If I keep choosing fear, fear will rule me.
If I keep choosing control, control will drive me.
If I keep choosing trust, trust will become the foundation I stand on.

This means that trust can't just be a concept I agree with. It has to be something I live out. I have to stop treating prayer like a last resort and start treating it like my first instinct. Instead of trying to figure everything out first and then coming to God when I hit a dead end, I have to start inviting Him in from the beginning. I have to stop reacting out of fear when something doesn't go the way I planned. When uncertainty creeps in, when I feel like I'm losing control, I have to stop and take a breath. I have to remind myself:

God is here.

God is working.

God is leading.

And then, I move forward—not out of panic, not out of desperation, but out of trust.

This also means **I have to stop grasping for things that were meant to be given.**

If I really believe that God knows what I need, then why am I still trying to force outcomes, manipulate situations, or anxiously chase after things that I was never meant to make happen on my own?

Because here's what I've learned—the more I practice trust, the more natural it becomes. At first, surrender feels foreign. It feels like loss. It feels like I'm letting go of something important. But over time, I start to realize I'm not actually losing anything that mattered.

I'm losing my need to prove myself.

I'm losing my fear of the unknown.

I'm losing the weight of feeling like everything is up to me.

And in its place, I'm gaining something I never had before.

I'm gaining peace—not because I have all the answers, but because I know the One who does.

I'm gaining clarity—not in my ability to predict the

future, but in knowing I don't have to.
I'm gaining joy—not in getting everything I want, but
in realizing that what I really wanted was God all
along.

I used to think surrender was about giving up.

Now I see it's about stepping into something so
much bigger than what I was trying to create for
myself.

So the question is no longer, *What do I need to do
to trust God?*

The question is, *Am I ready to start living like I
already do?*

Because the truth is, I could keep hesitating.
I could keep wrestling.
I could keep clinging to control—just in case.

Or...

I could take the next step.
I could stop striving and start walking.
I could stop second-guessing and start trusting.
I could stop holding back and actually step into the
life I was created for.

Because trust isn't built in thinking about surrender.
Trust is built in walking it out. And now that I know

that, I have one more question. Am I finally ready to live free?

17. What It Looks Like to Live Free

I've spent so much time talking about surrender, trust, and letting go. But now comes the real question—the one that matters most:

What does it actually look like to live this out?

Because it's easy to talk about trust when life feels steady, when nothing is being challenged, when things are working out the way I hoped. But what about when they don't? What about when fear creeps back in, when things go wrong, when uncertainty makes me want to take control again?

Living free isn't about having one big, life-changing moment of surrender and then never struggling again. It's not a single decision that instantly erases fear or doubt.

It's about the daily choices that keep my heart anchored in trust.

It's one thing to say, *God, I trust You*. It's another thing to actually wait on Him instead of forcing my own solutions.

For so long, I thought trust meant giving God my burdens while still keeping one hand on the wheel—just in case He didn't come through the

way I expected. But that's not trust. That's a backup plan. Living free means that when I face uncertainty, I pause instead of panic. Instead of scrambling to fix things, I lean in and listen. I pray before I plan. I let God speak before I take action. This doesn't mean I stop moving altogether. It means I stop moving without Him. Because trusting God isn't passive—it's active dependence. It's walking forward with Him, instead of ahead of Him.

If I say I trust God, then I can't live like I'm afraid of losing everything.

Living free means I stop gripping my desires so tightly that I can't receive what God is actually trying to give me. This doesn't mean I stop dreaming, stop hoping, stop wanting good things. It means I hold them loosely, knowing that if something is meant for me, God will bring it. And if it's not, then He has something better. It means I stop letting fear of the future steal the peace I'm meant to have right now. I don't have to fear what I might lose if I surrender—I have to trust that whatever is taken, whatever is left behind, whatever doesn't go according to my plan, is making space for something greater than I could have imagined.

I've lived my whole life thinking I have to make things happen. That my success, my security, my happiness all depend on me. That if I want

something, I have to fight for it, push for it, prove that I'm worthy of it.

But living free means walking away from that lie for good.

It means I stop hustling for my worth.

It means I stop obsessing over the future.

It means I stop carrying burdens that were never mine to carry.

It means I rest—not just physically, but deep in my soul.

Because when I trust that God is leading, I no longer have to fight for control.

I don't have to force open doors that He's already planning to unlock in His timing.

I don't have to carry the weight of figuring everything out.

I don't have to live exhausted, pouring all my energy into things that were never meant to sustain me.

I don't want trust to be the thing I turn to after I've exhausted all my own options.

I want trust to be my instinct.

That means when fear whispers, *What if this all falls apart?*—I don't spiral into anxiety. I remind myself, God has me. He has always had me. He will never stop holding me. That means when things don't go as planned, I don't react with frustration—I look for what God might be doing instead. That means when I face the unknown, I don't hesitate. I walk forward anyway, knowing that trust isn't about having all the answers. It's about knowing the One who does.

Because real trust isn't about waiting until everything makes sense before I move forward.

It's about moving forward because I know God is already there.

This might be the biggest shift of all.

For so long, I lived like life was something to be figured out, controlled, and managed. Like I had to constantly be on high alert, making sure I didn't mess things up, making sure I was always on the right path, making sure I didn't accidentally ruin everything.

But what if I was actually meant to enjoy this life? What if I was never supposed to carry all that pressure? What if freedom isn't just about trust—it's about joy?

Because the truth is: When I truly trust God, I don't just feel safe. I feel alive.

I stop overthinking every decision.

I stop second-guessing every step.

I stop being so consumed with the future that I miss the beauty of right now.

I start noticing God in the little things.

I start laughing more, worrying less.

I start actually living as if I am truly free.

Because I am.

This Is the Life I Was Made For.

Not a life of fear. Not a life of striving. Not a life of constant questioning.

A life where I am fully known, fully loved, fully at peace. This isn't just a nice concept. This isn't just a beautiful idea.

This is real.

And now, I have a decision to make. I can keep hesitating, keep wrestling, keep overcomplicating surrender...

Or I can finally step into the life I was made for.

18. Stepping Into the Life I Was Made For

I've spent so much time wrestling with trust, surrender, and letting go. I've questioned, hesitated, and held on just in case—just in case I needed a backup plan, just in case surrender didn't turn out the way I expected, just in case trust was too risky.

But now, I know what I have to do. I have to actually step into this.

Not just in theory. Not just in moments of clarity when trust feels easy. Not just in the highs of faith when I feel close to God. But in my real, everyday life, when the road ahead is uncertain, when fear tries to creep back in, when I don't have all the answers.

Because if I don't start living this out, then what was all of this for?

I don't want to keep circling the same fears, coming back to the same struggles, re-learning the same lessons over and over because I refuse to actually apply them. I don't want to stay stuck in a loop where I say I trust God but still hold on to control, where I long for peace but still choose striving, where I know the truth but don't actually walk in it.

I want to move forward. Not perfectly. Not without questions. Not without moments of struggle. But with a heart that is fully set on living free.

And what does this actually mean?

It means when fear creeps in, I don't let it dictate my choices.

I don't give in to panic. I don't let worry take the lead. I don't start scrambling to fix things on my own. Instead, I pause, I take a breath, and I remind myself: *God is here. He is still in control. I don't have to take over just because things feel uncertain.* It means when circumstances don't go the way I planned, I don't assume everything is falling apart.

I don't immediately think I've made a mistake. I don't start doubting that God is working just because I can't see what He's doing. Instead, I remind myself that His ways are higher than mine, His timing is better, and just because something looks wrong to me doesn't mean He isn't making it right. It means when I feel like I don't have enough—enough time, enough strength, enough clarity—I remind myself that God is always enough.

I stop believing that my limitations are what determine my future. I stop thinking that I have to

figure everything out before I move forward. I stop waiting for things to feel easy before I choose to trust. Because stepping into this life means I stop waiting for certainty and start moving forward anyway.

No More Waiting for Trust to Feel Easy

If I wait until trust feels easy, I'll never take the first step. If I wait until surrender feels comfortable, I'll never let go. So I stop expecting trust to be effortless and start choosing it even when it's hard. I stop seeing surrender as something I lose and start seeing it as the life I gain.

I stop hesitating, waiting for the moment when faith will suddenly feel natural, when trusting God will no longer feel like a risk.

Because that moment isn't coming. Trust isn't something that just happens to me—it's something I have to choose.

And I'm done waiting.

I'm done waiting for a perfect plan before I move. I'm done waiting for my feelings to catch up before I obey.

I'm done waiting for certainty before I take a step of faith.

I don't want to just talk about surrender. I want to live surrendered. I don't want to just agree with trust in theory. I want to walk in trust every day. Because this is what I was created for.

That's what this is really about.

I'm not just letting go of control—I'm walking into freedom.

I'm not just stopping striving—I'm stepping into peace.

I'm not just trusting God with my future—I'm learning to live fully present with Him right now.

Because this is the life I was made for—not a life where I constantly worry about what's ahead, not a life where I struggle under the weight of making everything happen, not a life where I spend every moment trying to protect myself from what I was never meant to control.

This is a life where I actually rest in God's presence. A life where I stop striving and start trusting. A life where I don't just know I'm free—I live like it.

Not because everything will suddenly feel easy. Not because fear will never try to creep back in. Not because I will never struggle with trust again.

But because I'm choosing to stop waiting. I'm choosing to stop holding back. I'm choosing to step into the life I was made for—even if my hands still shake, even if my heart still races, even if my faith is still learning how to stand firm. Because I don't need certainty to move forward. I just need faith. And now, I have one final question to ask myself:

Am I finally ready to live free?

Because if I am—

Then this is where everything changes.

19. Where Everything Changes

This is the turning point. This is where trust stops being an idea and starts shaping how I live. This is where surrender becomes more than a prayer—it becomes the foundation of my life.

For so long, I thought change would happen in a single moment—that one big realization, one powerful encounter with God, one breakthrough would be enough to reset everything inside me. I thought if I could just have a life-changing experience, everything would be different.

And while those moments do matter, I've realized that real change doesn't happen in one emotional moment. Real change happens in the daily decision to keep walking in trust, over and over again.

This is where everything changes—not because life suddenly gets easier, not because fear disappears forever, not because I suddenly understand everything, but because I start responding differently.

Because the circumstances don't have to change for me to change.

I stop making decisions out of fear.

I stop trying to control things that were never mine

to hold.

I stop believing the lie that I have to make everything work on my own.

And in that shift, something happens.

I start waking up with peace instead of pressure.
I start noticing God in the small, quiet moments.
I start trusting that even when I don't understand,
He is still leading me.

Because I am no longer living as if I am on my own.

I am no longer carrying the weight of my own survival.

I am no longer waiting for life to feel secure before I rest in God's security.

I am no longer striving for the things that God has already promised to give me.

It means I stop overanalyzing every step. I don't have to know every detail before I move forward, because I trust that God is already ahead of me. It means I stop waiting for perfect conditions before I surrender. I used to think surrender would feel right once everything in my life was stable—once I had clarity, once I had security, once I felt strong enough to let go.

But surrender is what creates the peace I've been longing for.

It means I stop holding onto my old ways of thinking, my old need for control, my old patterns of striving—because I was never meant to live like that.

I wasn't made to live with a heart full of worry and a mind full of fear. I wasn't created to carry everything on my own shoulders. I wasn't designed to live life as if God isn't in control.

So I have to start letting go—not just once, but every single day. I have to stop treating surrender like a one-time event and start seeing it as a way of life. Because I do believe God is good. I do believe He is leading me. I do believe I can trust Him with everything. And now, it's time to actually live like it.

No more holding back. No more hesitating. No more waiting until I feel ready. No more keeping control just in case. If I say I trust God, then I have to walk in trust, not just talk about it.

This is where everything changes.

Not in a single moment, but in the decision to keep choosing trust every day. Not in an emotional breakthrough, but in the quiet confidence that I

don't have to carry my own life anymore. Not in everything suddenly making sense, but in finally realizing it doesn't have to.

Because this is the life I was made for.

And now, I have to ask myself—Am I finally ready to step into it?

Because if I am—Then nothing will ever be the same.

20. Walking in This Daily

I don't want this to be something I just talk about. I don't want trust to be a concept I understand but never fully step into. I don't want to look back on my life and realize that I believed in surrender but never actually lived surrendered.

I want this to be how I live.

Because if I say I trust God, then my life should look different. My choices should reflect that I believe He is who He says He is. My heart should be at rest, not because everything is perfect, but because I actually believe He is holding me.

But this won't happen overnight.

This kind of trust isn't built in a single decision. It's not the result of one emotional breakthrough. It's not something that suddenly flips a switch and erases all my fear and doubt.

This kind of trust is built in the everyday moments.

It's built in the way I respond when things don't go my way.

It's built in the way I handle uncertainty.

It's built in the way I choose to stop striving and let Him lead.

Every single day, I have an opportunity to either live in trust or live in fear.

And that choice—made in the small, ordinary, unnoticed moments—is what determines whether trust becomes my new normal.

Living in trust means that when I wake up, my first thought isn't about my worries, my plans, or my next step—it's about who is walking with me through it all.

It means I stop letting anxiety take the lead. I stop waking up feeling like I have to figure out the day before it even begins. I stop treating my time with God like a box to check and start treating it like the foundation of my entire day.

Because if I truly trust Him, then He should be the first voice I listen to, not the last.

Living this out means that when fear creeps in, I don't let it control me. I recognize it, but I don't follow it. I feel it, but I don't make decisions based on it. I stop letting fear convince me that I have to take over. I stop letting worry dictate my next step. I stop giving anxiety permission to steal my peace.

Trust doesn't mean I'll never feel afraid. But it does mean I stop letting fear lead me. It means that

when things feel uncertain, I don't rush to fix them. I don't immediately try to find the fastest way out. I don't scramble to make things happen on my own.

Instead, I pause.

I breathe.

I listen.

I let God speak before I take action.

Because trust isn't just about what I believe. It's about how I live. And if I say I trust Him, then I should be living like someone who does. I want to live like someone who knows they are deeply loved. I want to walk like someone who knows they are completely held. I want to make decisions like someone who knows they are always led by God.

That kind of life doesn't happen by accident. It's built choice by choice, moment by moment, day by day. It's built in the way I wake up and set my mind on Him before anything else. It's built in the way I stop rushing, stop striving, stop trying to force things to happen on my own timeline.

It's built in the way I stay present, trusting that if I'm walking with God, then I don't have to run ahead of Him. It's built in the way I let go of the weight I was never meant to carry—not just once, but again and again, until trust becomes my default instead of control.

And the more I choose trust over fear, surrender over striving, faith over control, the more I will realize—

This is the life I was always meant to live.

For so long, I thought trust was something I would eventually achieve. I thought that if I grew enough, learned enough, prayed enough, then one day I would just wake up fully trusting, fully surrendered, fully free from fear.

But trust isn't a finish line I cross. It's a way of walking every single day.

That means when life is steady, I trust Him.

That means when things feel uncertain, I trust Him.

That means when fear whispers, *What if this doesn't work out?*—I trust Him.

That means when I don't feel strong enough, I trust Him to be strong for me.

And when I do this day after day, choice after choice, moment after moment, something happens. Trust stops feeling like something I have to force myself into and starts feeling like the most natural thing in the world. Because I stop seeing trust as a risk—and start seeing it as a refuge. I stop treating surrender like a sacrifice—and start treating it as a gift. I stop clinging to control as if it's my only safety

net—because I finally realize, God is the only security I will ever need.

This is what I was made for

I wasn't made for a life of constant worry. I wasn't made for a life of striving. I wasn't made to wake up carrying burdens I was never meant to hold. I was made to walk in trust. I was made to live in surrender. I was made to be fully free—not just in my beliefs, but in the way I actually live. And I know now, this isn't just something I want.

It's something I have to choose.

Every day.

Every moment.

Every step I take.

So this is what happens next: I walk this out. I live this in the ordinary moments. In the waiting. In the unknown. In the choices that seem small but shape my heart. I stop hesitating and start living in the freedom I was made for.

And no matter what comes next, I know this—

I am not walking alone.

21. The Journey Home

This whole time, I thought I was searching for answers. I thought I was looking for clarity, for direction, for the right path to take. I believed that if I could just figure out what to do next, everything else would fall into place.

But the truth is, I have been searching for something much deeper. Not only was I searching for a person;

I have been searching for home.

Not a place. Not a perfect set of circumstances. Not a life where everything finally aligns the way I imagined.

I have been searching for the place where my soul can breathe. The place where I don't have to prove my worth. The place where I don't have to keep striving, keep fixing, keep controlling.

Home isn't found in a destination. It's not found in the perfect job, the perfect plan, or the perfect version of myself that I keep chasing after.

Home is where I am fully known and still fully loved. Home is where I no longer have to strive to be enough.

Home is where my heart is at peace because I know I am exactly where I am meant to be.

And that home is found in God.

This whole journey—the wrestling, the surrender, the learning to trust—it has all been leading me back to the place I was always meant to be. I thought I was trying to move forward, to discover something new, to find the missing piece that would finally bring me peace. But I see now that this was never about finding something new—it was about returning to what has always been true.

Back to a life where I am not my own provider, my own protector, my own source of security. Back to a life where I don't have to fight for control, because I know I am already held.

Back to a life where I no longer chase after things that will never satisfy, because I have found the only thing that ever truly could.

Home has always been a person, not a place—not a destination, but a relationship. Home has never been about where I end up. It has always been about who I am with.

A return to the presence of the One who created me. A return to the trust I was always meant to live

in. A return to the freedom of knowing that I belong,
that I am safe, that I am loved.

And now, I finally see it.

The home I have been longing for, the peace I have
been chasing, the security I have been trying to
build for myself—

It was never something I had to create.

It was never something I had to earn.

It was always an Invitation

God has been calling me home this whole time.

Through every moment of striving, through every
fear that whispered I wasn't enough, through every
disappointment that made me doubt whether I was
on the right path—He has been calling me back to
Him.

And now, I am finally stepping into it. I am finally
letting go of the weight I was never meant to carry. I
am finally realizing that home is not something I will
find when everything is perfect—it is something I
can step into right now.

This is the journey.

Not toward more answers.
Not toward a perfectly planned future.
Not toward certainty about what's ahead.

But toward rest in the One who holds it all.

I am no longer wandering. I am no longer striving. I
am no longer searching for something I already
have.

I have come home.

And this is where my journey truly begins.

Epilogue: Walking This Out for Yourself

This isn't just my story. This is yours too.

If anything in these words has stirred something inside you—if you've felt that pull toward something deeper, if you're tired of carrying the weight of control and striving, if you've realized that there's more to life than constantly managing, fixing, and figuring everything out—then this journey isn't just mine.

It's yours to walk as well. But this isn't something you just understand in theory. It has to be lived. It has to be something you step into. Something you choose daily. Something that stops being just an idea and starts shaping how you actually live.

So I want to invite you into this.

Not just to read about trust, surrender, and freedom—but to actually experience it for yourself. Because there is a difference between knowing the truth and walking in it. And now, you have the opportunity to step into it for yourself.

This Is the Process

1. Start by asking the real questions.

Be honest with yourself and with God. No more surface-level prayers. No more avoiding the deeper issues.

What have you been chasing?

What are you afraid of?

Where have you been holding onto control?

What would it look like for you to truly trust Him?

These aren't easy questions, but they are necessary ones. Because before you can surrender, before you can fully step into trust, you have to see what has been keeping you from it.

2. Look at what's holding you back.

Fear. Doubt. Past wounds. False beliefs about who God is.

These things don't just disappear because you want them to.

You have to name them.

You have to confront them.

You have to decide if they are worth carrying any longer.

Because you can't step into freedom while still clinging to the chains of fear. You can't receive

peace while still holding onto the mindset of striving. At some point, you have to decide that trusting God is worth more than the illusion of control.

3. Surrender the weight.

You weren't meant to hold everything together.
You weren't meant to figure everything out.
You weren't meant to carry the full responsibility of your own survival.

So what are the things you keep gripping tightly?

What are the things you are afraid to let go of?

What would it look like to finally release them and trust that God has something better?

Because surrender isn't just about letting go. It's about stepping into something greater.

4. Learn to receive.

God isn't just asking you to let go—He's inviting you to receive.

Receive His love.
Receive His peace.
Receive His presence.

But receiving means you have to stop striving and start resting. It means you have to stop trying to earn what has already been given to you. It means you have to stop living like you are on your own and start living like you are held, secure, and fully known by Him.

This is where trust starts to feel real.

Not in the moment you let go, but in the moment you experience what God has been offering you all along.

5. Step into trust daily.

This isn't a one-time choice.

This is something you practice in the small moments. When fear rises, when control tries to creep back in, when life doesn't go as planned—that's when you make the decision to trust instead of falling into old patterns.

And over time, trust becomes your new normal. Over time, surrender stops feeling like loss and

starts feeling like relief. Over time, faith stops being something you struggle with and starts being something you stand on.

Because here's the thing—this isn't just a nice idea.

It's real.

You don't have to keep wrestling with whether or not you are safe.

You don't have to keep questioning if God is enough.

You don't have to keep wondering if you're doing enough to be loved.

You already are. And the more you start living like it, the more you will realize—this is the life you were created for.

Not a life of fear.

Not a life of striving.

Not a life of constantly trying to control the things that were never meant to be yours to control.

But a life of peace. A life of freedom. A life of trusting God, even when you don't have all the answers. And this is the invitation. To step out of striving and into trust. To stop waiting for the perfect moment to surrender and to start living in it right

now. Because trust isn't just about believing that God is trustworthy—it's about living like He is.

So the real question isn't: *Can you trust God?*

The real question is: *Will you?*

Because everything changes the moment you decide to actually live this. The moment you stop saying you want to trust God and start living as if you already do. The moment you stop letting fear make your decisions. The moment you stop waiting for things to feel easy before you surrender.

Because this life of trust, surrender, and freedom—

It's already yours.

You just have to step into it.